

ASE 230 Tools Installation - VS Code

Why VS Code?

1. VS Code is one of the most widely used code editors.
2. It supports the languages and tools used in this course.
3. Windows users can connect VS Code to WSL2.
4. It can preview Markdown files using its built-in preview — no extension required.

A deeper reference on VS Code extensions (Python, Git, testing, etc.) is in `VS Code Reference` in this same folder — optional, **not required for HW1**.

1. Install VS Code

1. Download from code.visualstudio.com

2. Verify the CLI tool:

```
code --version
```

Or run this automatically. A `run.sh` is just a script — a text file listing the same commands you'd otherwise type by hand — that

runs them all for you in one step. (Mac: installs via Homebrew.

WSL2:

VS Code itself must be installed on Windows, so this just checks and

tells you what's missing):

2. Open Your Project Folder

- In VS Code, a **folder** is a project: `File → Open Folder` (`Ctrl+K Ctrl+O` / `Cmd+K Cmd+O`).
- Open the folder where you downloaded or cloned the course repo, so
you can browse and edit everything in one window.

3. Read Markdown Files with the Preview

VS Code can preview `.md` files **out of the box** — no extension required:

1. Open any `.md` file (like this one, or `HW1.md`).
2. `Ctrl+Shift+V` / `Cmd+Shift+V` opens the preview pane.

Verification for HW1: open `HW1.md` in VS Code and confirm the preview pane renders the text correctly.

4. Open the Integrated Terminal (Run Any Code)

Shortcut: `Ctrl+`` / `Cmd+``

```
php --version      # you'll use this once PHP is installed
git status         # Git integration works here too
```

Run every command in this course's slides from inside this terminal
(or your regular terminal), not by typing into the editor pane.

5. Windows Only: Connect VS Code to WSL2

1. Install the "**Remote - WSL**" extension.
2. `Ctrl+Shift+P` → "WSL: Connect to WSL" (or reopen your project folder from inside the WSL2 terminal with `code .`).
3. The bottom-left corner should now say "**WSL: Ubuntu**" — this confirms VS Code is editing files inside WSL2, not on Windows directly, which matters because PHP/MySQL are installed there.

6. Install PHP-Related Extensions

- **PHP Intelephense** – autocomplete, error checking
- **PHP Debug** – step-through debugging

(Install via the Extensions view: `Ctrl+Shift+X` / `Cmd+Shift+X`

→

search → Install.)

7. Verify Your Setup

- [] `code --version` runs in your terminal
- [] Your project folder is open in VS Code
- [] `HW1.md`'s preview pane renders correctly
(`Ctrl+Shift+V`)
- [] The integrated terminal opens (`Ctrl+``)
- [] Windows only: bottom-left corner shows "WSL: Ubuntu"
- [] PHP Intelephense and PHP Debug are installed